

Excellent. This is probably my favorite section because it's where the app stops being "just another assignment app" and starts becoming a community.

Assignment Guy

Product Requirements Document (PRD)

Document 1 — Part 3

Community, Reputation & User System

14. Community Philosophy

Assignment Guy is built on the belief that students often help one another.

The platform should encourage and recognize those contributions while maintaining a welcoming environment for everyone.

Users should feel that helping others improves the quality of the platform for the entire class.

The goal is to build a trusted community rather than a competitive one.

15. User Roles

Version 1 includes four user roles.

Student

Default role.

Every new user begins here.

Permissions:

View assignments

Upload assignments

Participate in discussions

Update personal assignment status

Use AI Help

Report incorrect information

Contributor

Students who consistently contribute useful content.

Contributions may include:

Uploading assignments

Adding context

Improving assignment descriptions

Helping in discussions

Correcting mistakes

Contributors receive recognition within the platform.

Trusted Contributor ("Assignment Guy")

This is a community recognition, not a staff position.

Trusted Contributors are students who have repeatedly demonstrated accuracy, reliability, and helpfulness.

Potential privileges:

Priority badge

Higher trust score

Ability to improve assignment details

Faster review of edits

Community recognition

Assignment Guy is earned through participation rather than requested.

Administrator

Responsible for moderation and platform management.

Permissions include:

Remove inappropriate content

Manage reports

Suspend users

Edit platform settings

Manage trusted contributors

16. Reputation System

The platform rewards helpful behavior rather than popularity.

Students earn reputation through meaningful contributions.

Examples:

Uploading assignments

Providing accurate context

Answering questions

Correcting mistakes

Uploading clearer files

Reporting incorrect information

Reputation should never be purchasable.

Reputation Goals

Encourage participation.

Promote accuracy.

Recognize consistency.

Build trust.

17. Contribution Score

Each helpful action increases a student's Contribution Score.

Example activities:

Activity Example Weight

Upload assignment High

Add useful context Medium

Upload better attachment Medium

Helpful discussion Medium
Correct wrong information Medium
Report duplicate assignment Low
Report spam Low

The exact numbers are intentionally omitted in the PRD so they can be tuned after testing.

18. Recognition

Rather than displaying large point totals everywhere, recognition should feel subtle.

Examples:

"Trusted Contributor"

"Top Helper"

"Assignment Guy"

The purpose is appreciation, not competition.

19. Community Guidelines

Assignment Guy is designed for academic collaboration.

Users are expected to:

Stay respectful.

Remain on topic.

Avoid harassment.

Avoid spam.

Avoid intentionally misleading classmates.

Discussions should focus on helping students understand assignments and share relevant information.

20. Reporting System

Users can report:

Spam

Duplicate assignments

Incorrect information

Offensive content

Misleading uploads

Reported content enters a moderation queue.

21. Moderation Philosophy

Moderation should be as lightweight as possible.

Most issues should be handled through community reports rather than constant administrator intervention.

Only repeated or serious violations should require account restrictions.

22. Assignment Ownership

When a student uploads an assignment, they become its original contributor.

However, Assignment Guy is collaborative.

Other trusted users may:

Add context.

Improve formatting.

Correct mistakes.

Upload clearer files.

The original upload should always remain credited.

23. Duplicate Assignments

Duplicate uploads are expected.

Instead of creating confusion:

The platform should detect likely duplicates.

Users can:

Merge discussions.

Replace lower-quality uploads.

Keep the clearer version.

This helps prevent fragmented conversations.

24. Trust Over Popularity

Assignment Guy should never become a popularity contest.

Helpful information should be easier to discover than popular opinions.

Features like "likes" should never overshadow factual accuracy.

Recognition should come from reliable contributions, not social influence.

25. Emergency Answer Community Rule

Emergency Answer is not intended to replace learning.

It exists for exceptional situations.

The platform may require positive community participation before allowing access.

The exact unlocking rules remain experimental and may evolve after observing real user behavior during Version 1.

26. Abuse Prevention

The platform should discourage abuse without making normal use frustrating.

Examples of potential abuse:

Fake assignments

Repeated duplicate uploads

Spam comments

Misleading answers

Artificially inflating contribution scores

False reports

The system should log suspicious activity and allow moderators to review it.

27. Version 1 Scope

Version 1 intentionally keeps the community system simple.

Included:

Basic roles

Contribution tracking

Reporting

Recognition badges

Trusted Contributors

Not included:

Leaderboards

Gamification

Achievement systems

Streaks

Competitive rankings

The focus is on usefulness rather than competition.

End of Document 1 — Part 3

A few thoughts after writing this section

While writing it, I realized something that could become one of Assignment Guy's strongest ideas:

The app doesn't rely on lecturers to stay alive.

Many student platforms fail because they need lecturers to upload everything. Your design is different—the students themselves keep it updated. If the community finds value in it, the content continues to grow even without official involvement.

One suggestion I'd make for the future (not Version 1) is to introduce Course Guardians. Instead of moderators assigned by you, each course could naturally have one or two trusted contributors who keep that course organized. It would be an evolution of the "Assignment Guy" role rather than a separate staff position.

We're now finished with the product philosophy and community design. Next comes the User Experience (UX): every screen, every navigation flow, and what the user sees from the moment they open the app until they submit an assignment. That's where the product starts to feel tangible.